

$E=mc^2 = E=m$: Two Equivalent Perspectives Unit
Conventions in Relativity Theory From SI Units to Natural
Units

Contents

.1	The Central Thesis: $E=mc^2 = E=m$	2
	The Mathematical Identity	2
	What is c really?	2
.2	The Convention Choice: The Constant-Setting of c	2
	The Act of Constant-Setting	2
	The Problem of Time Variability	2
	The T0 Resolution	3
.3	Constant-Setting from the T0 Viewpoint	3
	The Mechanism of Constant-Setting	3
	What Really Happens (T0 View)	3
.4	c as Ratio vs. c as Constant	3
	c as Natural Ratio (T0)	3
	c as Fixed Constant (Einstein)	3
.5	The Time Dilation Paradox	4
	The Tension from the T0 Viewpoint	4
	The Solution of Relativity Theory	4
	The Solution in T0 Theory	4
.6	The Mathematical Demonstration	4
	From $E=mc^2$ to $E=m$	4
	The Reverse Direction: From $E=m$ to $E=mc^2$	5
.7	The Practical Justification of $E = mc^2$ in Our Experiential Realm	5
	$E = mc^2$ and $E = m$ – Same Content in Different Unit Systems	5
	Why the Fixation $c = \text{const.}$ Is Practically Reasonable	5
	The Crucial Distinction: Practical Convention vs. Fundamental Natural Law	6
	Einstein's Historical Achievement in New Light	7
	From Practical to Fundamental Description: A Historical Progression	7
	Coexistence of Both Descriptions: A Peaceful Expansion	7
	The Actual Concern of T0 Theory	8
	The Double Perspective: Practical Engineering vs. Fundamental Science	8
.8	The Arbitrariness of Constant Choice: c or Time?	9
	Einstein's Choice	9
	Option 1: Einstein's c -constant	9
	Option 2: Time-constant (Einstein could have chosen)	10
	Mathematical Equivalence of Both Options	10
	Why Einstein Chose Option 1	10
	The T0 View of Both Options	10
	Liberation from Constant Constraint	11
.9	The Change of Reference Point: Earth $\rightarrow$ Sun $\rightarrow$ Nature	11
	The Reference Point Analogy: Geocentric $\rightarrow$ Heliocentric $\rightarrow$ T0	11
	Why We Need Reference Points	11
	Two Reference Points Compared	12

.10	When Something Becomes "Constant"	12
	The Fundamental Reference Point Problem	12
	The Natural Stage: Everything is Relative	12
	The Moment of Reference Point Setting	13
	The Reference Point Problematic	13
	T0's Reference Point-Free Physics	13
	Example: The Meter Definition	13
	The Circularity: Humans Define Their Own "Constants"	14
	The T0 View of Reference Points	14
.11	Why c-Constancy is Not Provable	14
	The Fundamental Measurement Problem	14
	The Gauge Definition Problem	14
	The Systematic Compensation Problem	15
	The Burden of Proof Problem	15
	T0 Prediction for Precise Measurements	15
.12	Ontological Consideration: Calculations as Constructs	15
	The Fundamental Epistemological Limit	15
	Einstein's Construct vs. T0's Construct	15
	The Ontological Relativity	16
	Why T0 May Still Be Preferable	16
	The Epistemological Humility	16
	The Pragmatic Consequence	17
	The Ontological Humility	17
.13	The Practical Consequences	17
	Why $E=mc^2$ "Works"	17
	When $E=mc^2$ Fails	17
	T0's Universal Validity	17
.14	A Reinterpretation of Physics History	18
	Einstein's Achievement from the T0 Viewpoint	18
	The Historical Classification	18
.15	The T0 Perspective: c as Living Ratio	18
	c as Expression of Time-Mass Duality	18
	The Dynamic Speed of Light	18
.16	Experimental Tests of c-Variability	18
	Proposed Experiments	18
	Expected Results	19

Correction notes

Corrections from the calculation review (30 Sept. 2026). The following places are corrected or annotated in the text; each carries a dated note there with the previous value:

- "Einstein's choice", "Einstein set" and "Reference point of relativity theory (Einstein)": $c = 299\,792\,458$ m/s as Einstein's setting → Einstein postulated the constancy of c ; the numerical value has been fixed by definition since 1983 (17th CGPM).
- Metre definition of 1793: "1/10,000,000 of Earth meridian" → of the meridian quadrant (pole to equator).

Note on the corpus status: variable speed of light. The idea of a varying speed of light referred to in this document has been replaced in the later corpus by *fractal path lengthening*: the geometric stretching of the propagation path in the ξ field (Doc. 026, 149, 182; achromatic according to K6 in Doc. 190). Statements that rely on a variable speed of light are to be read accordingly.

Abstract

This work shows the central point of Einstein's relativity theory: $E=mc^2$ is mathematically identical to $E=m$. The only difference lies in Einstein's treatment of c as a "constant" instead of a dynamic ratio. By fixing $c = 299,792,458$ m/s, the natural time-mass duality $T \cdot m = 1$ is "frozen," leading to apparent complexity. The T0 theory puts forward the thesis: c is not a fundamental law of nature, but a ratio that must be variable if time is variable. The choice of convention concerned not $E=mc^2$ itself, but the constant-setting of c .

Note on versions. The German version of this document is more extensive than this English one. Earlier revisions shortened or changed parts of the English version. Where the two differ, the more extensive German version applies.

Status markers. Statements marked **[S]** are *speculative*: a hint or conjecture that has not yet been derived or numerically checked in the corpus.

.1 The Central Thesis: $E=mc^2 = E=m$

The Central Thesis

$E=mc^2$ and $E=m$ are mathematically identical in natural units.

In the T0 reading, the difference is that Einstein treats c as a "constant," while T0 theory regards c as a dynamic ratio.

Einstein's choice: $c = \text{constant}$ (postulate; the numerical value 299,792,458 m/s has been fixed by SI definition since 1983) (*Corrected on 30 Sept. 2026: previously "c = 299,792,458 m/s" as Einstein's setting – Einstein postulated the constancy of c , not a numerical value; the numerical value has been fixed by definition since 1983 (17th CGPM).*)

T0 view: $c = L/T = \text{variable ratio}$

The Mathematical Identity

In natural units:

$$E = mc^2 = m \times c^2 = m \times 1^2 = m \quad (1)$$

This is not an approximation but the same equation in different units.

What is c really?

$$c = \frac{\text{Length}}{\text{Time}} = \frac{L}{T} \quad (2)$$

In the T0 reading, c is a ratio, not a natural constant.

.2 The Convention Choice: The Constant-Setting of c

The Act of Constant-Setting

Einstein set: $c = \text{constant}$ (postulate of 1905; the numerical value 299,792,458 m/s has been fixed by the 17th CGPM since 1983) (*Corrected on 30 Sept. 2026: previously "c = 299,792,458 m/s" as Einstein's setting – Einstein postulated the constancy of c, not a numerical value; the numerical value has been fixed by definition since 1983 (17th CGPM).)*

What does this mean?

$$c = \frac{L}{T} = \text{constant} \Rightarrow \frac{L}{T} = \text{fixed} \quad (3)$$

Implication: If L and T can vary, their **ratio** must remain constant.

The Problem of Time Variability

Einstein recognized himself: Time dilates.

$$t' = \gamma t \quad (\text{time is variable}) \quad (4)$$

At the same time he set:

$$c = \frac{L}{T} = \text{constant} \quad (5)$$

From the T0 viewpoint this is a tension. Relativity theory resolves it through the joint transformation of length and time; T0 theory resolves it in a different way.

The T0 Resolution

T0 insight: $T(x, t) \cdot m = 1$

This means:

- Time $T(x, t)$ **must** be variable (coupled to mass)
- Therefore $c = L/T$ **cannot** be constant
- c is a **dynamic ratio**, not a constant

.3 Constant-Setting from the T0 Viewpoint

The Mechanism of Constant-Setting

Step 1: Einstein sets $c = \text{constant}$

$$c = 299,792,458 \text{ m/s} = \text{fixed} \quad (6)$$

Step 2: Time becomes "frozen" by this

$$T = \frac{L}{c} = \frac{L}{\text{constant}} = \text{apparently determined} \quad (7)$$

Step 3: Time dilation becomes "mysterious effect"

$$t' = \gamma t \quad (\text{explained via relativity theory}) \quad (8)$$

What Really Happens (T0 View)

T0 view: Time is variable through $T(x, t) \cdot m = 1$

Einstein's constant-setting "freezes" this variability

Result: The "frozen" dynamics must be captured through additional formalism (Lorentz transformations)

.4 c as Ratio vs. c as Constant

c as Natural Ratio (T0)

$$c(x, t) = \frac{L(x, t)}{T(x, t)} \quad (9)$$

Properties:

- c varies with location and time
- c follows the time-mass duality
- No fixed constants
- Natural simplicity: $E = m$

c as Fixed Constant (Einstein)

$$c = 299,792,458 \text{ m/s} = \text{constant everywhere} \quad (10)$$

Problems from the T0 viewpoint:

- Tension with time dilation
- "Freezing" of time dynamics
- Additional formalism needed
- Unit factor in the formula: $E = mc^2$

.5 The Time Dilation Paradox

The Tension from the T0 Viewpoint

Relativity theory sets simultaneously:

$$c = \text{constant} \quad (11)$$

$$t' = \gamma t \quad (\text{time varies}) \quad (12)$$

But:

$$c = \frac{L}{T} \quad \text{and} \quad T \text{ varies} \quad \Rightarrow \quad c \text{ cannot be constant} \quad (13)$$

The Solution of Relativity Theory

Relativity theory handles this through:

- Lorentz transformations
- Mathematical formalisms
- Space-time constructions
- **From the T0 viewpoint it remains open why c in particular is fixed.**

The Solution in T0 Theory

In T0 theory:

$$T(x, t) \cdot m = 1 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{time is naturally variable} \quad (14)$$

$$c = \frac{L}{T} \quad \Rightarrow \quad c \text{ is naturally variable} \quad (15)$$

No constant-setting $\rightarrow$ no such tension $\rightarrow$ no additional formalism

.6 The Mathematical Demonstration

From $E=mc^2$ to $E=m$

Starting equation: $E = mc^2$

c in natural units: $c = 1$

Substitution:

$$E = mc^2 = m \times 1^2 = m \quad (16)$$

Result: $E = m$

The Reverse Direction: From $E=m$ to $E=mc^2$

Starting equation: $E = m$

Introducing the constant: $c = 299,792,458 \text{ m/s}$

Rewriting the equation:

$$E = m = m \times 1 = m \times \frac{c^2}{c^2} = m \times c^2 \times \frac{1}{c^2} \quad (17)$$

If one defines c^2 as "conversion factor":

$$E = mc^2 \quad (18)$$

This shows: $E = mc^2$ is $E = m$ with the **conversion factor** c^2 .

.7 The Practical Justification of $E = mc^2$ in Our Experiential Realm

$E = mc^2$ and $E = m$ – Same Content in Different Unit Systems

The Pragmatic Perspective: Unit Systems and Conventions

The key point: The equation $E = mc^2$ is mathematically equivalent to $E = m$ when one chooses suitable units.

Einstein formulated in SI units (practical for our world):

$$E = m \cdot (299\,792\,458)^2 \text{ J} \quad (19)$$

TO formulates in natural units (fundamentally simpler):

$$E = m \quad \text{with} \quad c = 1 \quad (20)$$

Both descriptions contain exactly the same physical information – they merely use different measuring rods.

The choice between them is not a question of "right" or "wrong," but of *practical suitability versus fundamental simplicity*.

Why the Fixation $c = \text{const.}$ Is Practically Reasonable

For our everyday experiential world, the establishment of c as a constant is not only historically understandable but also *pragmatically justified* from multiple perspectives:

- 1. Measurement Practice:** All our measuring instruments (clocks, rulers, electronic devices) utilize physical processes that themselves depend on c . Establishing a fixed c creates a consistent reference framework for reproducible experiments. Without such a convention, every measurement would require a circular self-calibration.
- 2. Technological Applications:** From GPS navigation to particle accelerator technology, practical applications are based on the assumption of a locally constant c . This assumption works with extremely high precision for the range in which we live and work. The error introduced by this assumption is far below the resolution of our current technology for most applications.
- 3. Scientific Communication:** A uniform convention allows scientists worldwide to compare results and communicate with each other. The SI units with fixed c provide a practical basis for this. Science requires shared languages, and measurement conventions form an essential part of this language.
- 4. Historical Development:** The establishment of c as constant did not occur arbitrarily but emerged from centuries of measurement attempts (Roemer, Fizeau, Michelson-Morley) that within their accuracy showed no variation. Einstein built on this empirical foundation.
- 5. Educational Transmission:** Complex theories require entry points. $E = mc^2$ with constant c provides such an entry point into relativistic thinking. The deeper insight $E = m$ can follow as a second step for those seeking the fundamental structure.

The Crucial Distinction: Practical Convention vs. Fundamental Natural Law

TO Theory distinguishes two levels:

Practical Measurement Convention	Fundamental Natural Law
For technical applications and everyday experiments, fixing $c = 299\,792\,458$ m/s is sensible and useful.	On the most fundamental level, c is not an absolute natural constant but a dynamic ratio L/T that follows the time-mass duality $T \cdot m = 1$.
Corresponds to selecting a stable reference system for our world of experience.	Is meant to correspond to the intrinsic structure of reality before any human conventions.
Necessary for building reproducible technology and conducting comparable experiments.	Necessary for understanding the ultimate principles behind the phenomena.
Works for 99.9% of all current applications.	Shows what remains when all practical conventions are removed.

Table 1: The dual nature of physical descriptions

Einstein's Historical Achievement in New Light

Einstein's Achievement from the T0 Viewpoint

Einstein found the energy-mass equivalence (in natural units $E = m$) and formulated it in the *units practical for his time* as $E = mc^2$.

His historical achievement from the T0 perspective consists of three levels:

1. **Discovery of the fundamental relationship:** Recognizing that energy and mass are different manifestations of the same reality.
2. **Pragmatic formulation:** Expressing this insight in a form usable for experiments and verifiable by contemporary measurements.
3. **Conceptual reorganization:** Drawing the consequences for our space-time conception and thereby overcoming Newtonian absolutism.

The T0 Theory does not diminish this achievement but shows that behind the practical form $E = mc^2$ lies an even more fundamental simplicity $E = m$. From the T0 viewpoint Einstein stopped one step before this simpler form – a step that was appropriate for his time.

Remark: In natural units Einstein's relation reads $E = m$; he wrote it as $E = mc^2$ because this corresponded to the measurement practices of his time. That both forms express the same statement is familiar in theoretical physics; T0 theory attributes fundamental significance to the simple form.

From Practical to Fundamental Description: A Historical Progression

The development of physics can be understood as a continuous refinement of our reference systems and recognition of which elements are conventions and which are intrinsic structures:

Stage	Practical Form	Fundamental Insight	Historical Context
Newtonian Physics	$F = m \cdot a$ (with absolute time and space)	Approximation for $v \ll c$	Industrial Age: Machines, mechanics, predictable motion
Einstein (Special Relativity)	$E = mc^2$ (with $c = \text{const.}$)	Energy-mass equivalence	Early 20th Century: Electromagnetism, early atomic physics
Einstein (General Relativity)	$G_{\mu\nu} = \frac{8\pi G}{c^4} T_{\mu\nu}$ (10 field equations)	Geometry as gravity	Age of astronomy, cosmology
Quantum Mechanics	$i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \psi = H\psi$	Quantization of energy	Atomic and nuclear age
T0 Theory	$E = m$ in natural units (with $T \cdot m = 1$)	Time-mass duality as fundamental	Information Age: Search for unified principles

Table 2: Historical progression from practical to fundamental descriptions

Each stage retains the validity of the previous ones for their application area but expands understanding to a deeper level. Newton is not “wrong” but limited in scope. Einstein is not “wrong” but stopped at a certain level of convention. T0 seeks to go one step further – but does not invalidate the previous steps.

Coexistence of Both Descriptions: A Peaceful Expansion

T0 Theory proposes not a break with established physics but a peaceful expansion:

- **For 99.9% of all technical applications:** $E = mc^2$ with constant c remains the practical and correct formulation. All engineering, GPS technology, particle accelerators, and space travel can continue to work with the established equations.
- **For fundamental theoretical questions:** $E = m$ in natural units shows the actual simplicity of the energy-mass relationship and avoids the tension described above (the time dilation paradox from the T0 viewpoint). Theoretical physicists gain a simpler, more consistent foundation.
- **For future precision experiments:** The possibility of tiny c variations (as predicted by T0) should be kept in mind. Experiments can be designed to test whether c is *exactly* constant or only *practically* constant within our measurement accuracy.
- **For educational purposes:** The relationship can be taught at two levels: first the practical level $E = mc^2$ (as done today), then the fundamental level $E = m$ for advanced students. This corresponds to teaching Newtonian mechanics before relativity.

The Peaceful Expansion

The insight that $E = mc^2 = E = m$ does not require us to discard existing physics books or redesign technical systems. It only requires us to recognize that we have been working with a particularly practical form of a simpler basic form.

The change is conceptual, not practical.

The Actual Concern of T0 Theory

The Concern of T0 Theory

T0 does not want to abolish $E = mc^2$ as a practical equation but to show:

That behind the practical form lies a fundamental simplicity that has been obscured by the historical choice of units.

This insight does not free us from the necessity of practical conventions but opens a deeper understanding of what these conventions actually describe.

The goal: Not to make physics more complicated, but to recognize its inherent simplicity – and then consciously choose which level of description is appropriate for which purpose.

The Double Perspective: Practical Engineering vs. Fundamental Science

The T0 view allows a double perspective:

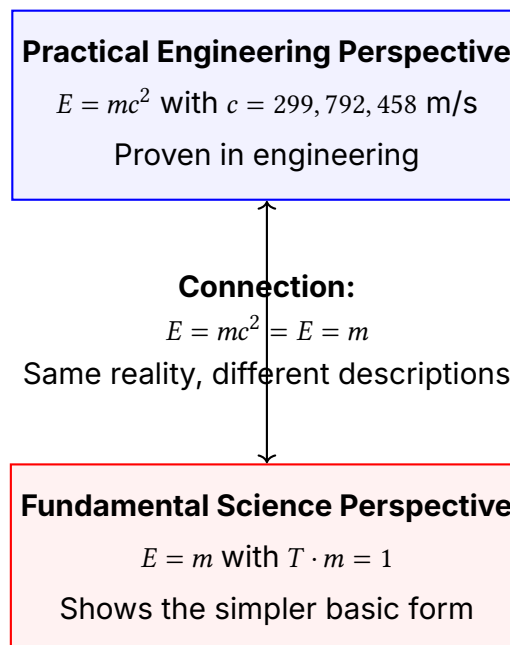


Figure 1: The double perspective of T0 Theory

Both perspectives are valid and useful – for different purposes. The engineer needs the practical perspective to build reliable technology. The theoretical physicist seeks the fundamental perspective to understand ultimate principles. T0 shows that these are not contradictory but complementary views of the same reality.

.8 The Arbitrariness of Constant Choice: c or Time?

Einstein's Choice

The Fundamental Choice Option

One can choose what should be "constant".

Option 1 (Einstein's choice): $c = \text{constant} \rightarrow \text{time becomes variable}$

Option 2 (alternative): $\text{time} = \text{constant} \rightarrow c \text{ becomes variable}$

Both describe the same physics.

Option 1: Einstein's c-constant

Einstein chose:

$$c = 299,792,458 \text{ m/s} = \text{constant (defined)} \quad (21)$$

$$t' = \gamma t \quad (\text{time becomes automatically variable}) \quad (22)$$

Language convention:

- "Speed of light is universally constant"
- "Time dilates in strong gravitational fields"
- "Clocks run slower at high velocities"

Option 2: Time-constant (Einstein could have chosen)

Alternative choice:

$$t = \text{constant (defined)} \quad (23)$$

$$c(x, t) = \frac{L(x, t)}{t} = \text{variable} \quad (24)$$

Alternative language convention:

- "Time flows equally everywhere"
- "Speed of light varies with location"
- "Light becomes slower in strong gravitational fields"

Mathematical Equivalence of Both Options

Both descriptions are mathematically identical:

Phenomenon	Einstein view	Time-constant view
Gravitation	Time slows down	Light slows down
Velocity	Time dilation	c-variation
GPS correction	"Clocks run differently"	"c is different"
Measurements	Same numbers	Same numbers

Table 3: Two views, identical physics

Why Einstein Chose Option 1

Historical reasons for Einstein's decision:

- **Michelson-Morley:** c seemed locally constant
- **Aesthetics:** "Universal constant" sounded elegant
- **Tradition:** Newtonian constant physics
- **Conceivability:** c-constancy easier to imagine than time constancy
- **Reception history:** Einstein's later reputation consolidated this choice
From the T0 viewpoint it was a convention, not a natural law.

The T0 View of Both Options

T0 thesis: Both choices are conventions.

$$T(x, t) \cdot m = 1 \quad (\text{natural duality without constant constraint}) \quad (25)$$

T0 insight:

- **Neither** c nor time are "really" constant
- **Both** are aspects of the same T·m dynamics
- **Constancy** is only definition convention
- **E = m** is the constant-free form

Liberation from Constant Constraint

Instead of choosing between:

- c constant, time variable (Einstein)
- Time constant, c variable (alternative)

T0 chooses:

- **Both dynamically coupled** via $T \cdot m = 1$
- **No arbitrary fixations**
- **Natural ratios** instead of fixed constants

.9 The Change of Reference Point: Earth → Sun → Nature

The Reference Point Analogy: Geocentric → Heliocentric → T0

The Change of Reference Point: From Earth → Sun → Nature

Geocentric (Ptolemy): Earth at center

- Complicated epicycles needed
- Works, but artificially complicated

Heliocentric (Copernicus): Sun at center

- Simple ellipses
- Considerably simpler

T0-centric: Natural ratios at center

- $T(x, t) \cdot m = 1$ (natural reference point)
- Simpler form: $E = m$

In this analogy, Einstein's c-constant corresponds to the geocentric system:

- **Human** reference point at center (like Earth at center)
- **Complicated** mathematics needed (like epicycles)
- **Works** locally, with additional formalism

T0's natural ratios correspond to the heliocentric system:

- **Natural** reference point at center (like Sun at center)
- **Simple** mathematics (like ellipses)
- **Universally** intended and simple

Why We Need Reference Points

Reference points are necessary and natural:

- **For measurements:** We need standards for comparison
- **For communication:** Common basis for exchange
- **For technology:** Practical applications require units
- **For science:** Reproducible experiments need standards

The question is not WHETHER, but WHICH reference point:

System	Reference Point	Complexity	Simplicity (T0 assessment)
Geocentric	Earth	Epicycles	Low
Heliocentric	Sun	Ellipses	High
Einstein	c-constant	Relativity theory	Medium
T0	$T(x, t) \cdot m = 1$	$E = m$	Maximum

Table 4: Reference point systems comparison

Two Reference Points Compared

The approach was not to choose a reference point:

- **But which reference point to choose.**

Reference point of relativity theory (Einstein): c = constant (numerical value 299,792,458 m/s by SI definition since 1983) *(Corrected on 30 Sept. 2026: previously "c = 299,792,458 m/s" as Einstein's setting – Einstein postulated the constancy of c , not a numerical value; the numerical value has been fixed by definition since 1983 (17th CGPM).)*

- Based on human definition
- Leads to complicated mathematics
- Leads, from the T0 viewpoint, to conceptual tensions

Reference point of T0 theory: $T(x, t) \cdot m = 1$

- Based on natural ratio
- Leads to simple mathematics: $E = m$
- No such tensions

.10 When Something Becomes "Constant"

The Fundamental Reference Point Problem

Reference Point and Constancy

Something only becomes "constant" when we define a reference point.

Without reference point: All ratios are relative and dynamic

With reference point: One ratio becomes artificially "fixed"

Einstein's approach: He defined an absolute reference point for c

The Natural Stage: Everything is Relative

Before any reference point definition:

$$c_1 = \frac{L_1}{T_1} \quad (26)$$

$$c_2 = \frac{L_2}{T_2} \quad (27)$$

$$c_3 = \frac{L_3}{T_3} \quad (28)$$

$$\vdots \quad (29)$$

All c -values are relative to each other. None is "constant".

The Moment of Reference Point Setting

The step of fixing:

$$\text{Fixing: } c = 299,792,458 \text{ m/s} = \text{reference point} \quad (30)$$

What happens at this moment:

- An **arbitrary reference point** is set
- All other c -values are measured relative to this
- The **dynamic ratio** becomes a "constant"
- The **natural relativity** is artificially "frozen"

The Reference Point Problematic

Every reference point is arbitrary:

- Why 299,792,458 m/s and not 300,000,000 m/s?
- Why in m/s and not in other units?
- Why measured on Earth and not in space?
- Why at this time and not at another?

T0's Reference Point-Free Physics

T0 does without a fixed reference point:

$$T(x, t) \cdot m = 1 \quad (\text{universal relation without reference point}) \quad (31)$$

- No arbitrary fixations
- All ratios remain dynamic
- Natural relativity is preserved
- Fundamental simplicity: $E = m$

Example: The Meter Definition

Historical development of meter definition:

1. **1793**: 1 meter = 1/10,000,000 of the Earth meridian quadrant, pole to equator (Earth reference point)
2. **1889**: 1 meter = prototype meter in Paris (object reference point)
3. **1960**: 1 meter = 1,650,763.73 wavelengths of krypton-86 (atom reference point)
4. **1983**: 1 meter = distance light travels in 1/299,792,458 s (c reference point)

What does this show?

- Each definition is a **human stipulation**
- The **reference point** changes with human technology
- There is **no "natural" length unit** - only human agreements
- **Since 1983 the numerical value of c has been fixed by definition**, not by measurement

The Circularity: Humans Define Their Own "Constants"

In 1983 humans defined:

$$1 \text{ meter} = \frac{1}{299,792,458} \times c \times 1 \text{ second} \quad (32)$$

This makes c automatically "constant" - through human definition, not through natural law:

$$c = \frac{299,792,458 \text{ meters}}{1 \text{ second}} = 299,792,458 \text{ m/s} \quad (33)$$

Circularity: Whoever defines c as constant obtains the same numerical value in every measurement in these units.

Whether c varies physically cannot be read off from the numerical value in this way.

The T0 View of Reference Points

T0 recognizes:

- **Definition** $\neq$ **natural law**
- **Measurement reference point** $\neq$ **physical constant**
- **Practical agreement** $\neq$ **fundamental structure**

T0 solution:

For measurements: Use practical reference points (34)

For natural laws: Use reference point-free relations (35)

.11 Why c-Constancy is Not Provable

The Fundamental Measurement Problem

To measure c , we need:

$$c = \frac{L}{T} \quad (36)$$

But: We measure L and T with **the same physical processes** that depend on c .

Circular problem:

- Light measures distances $\rightarrow c$ determines L
- Atomic clocks use EM transitions $\rightarrow c$ influences T
- Then we measure $c = L/T \rightarrow$ **We measure c with c .**

The Gauge Definition Problem

Since 1983: 1 meter = distance light travels in $1/299,792,458$ s

$$c = 299,792,458 \text{ m/s} \quad (\text{not measured, but defined}) \quad (37)$$

One cannot "prove" what one has defined.

The Systematic Compensation Problem

If c varies, ALL measuring devices vary equally:

- **Laser interferometers:** use light (c -dependent)
 - **Atomic clocks:** use EM transitions (c -dependent)
 - **Electronics:** uses EM signals (c -dependent)
- Result:** All devices would **largely compensate** a c -variation.

The Burden of Proof Problem

Scientifically correct:

- One **cannot prove** that something is constant
- One can only show that it **appears constant within measurement precision**
- **Each new precision level** could show variation

The constancy of c is a postulate confirmed within measurement precision, not a proof in the strict sense.

T0 Prediction for Precise Measurements

T0 prediction [S]: At highest precision T0 theory expects:

$$c(x, t) = c_0 \left(1 + \xi \times \frac{T(x, t)(x, t) - T(x, t)_0}{T(x, t)_0} \right) \quad (38)$$

with $\xi = 1.33 \times 10^{-4}$ (T0 parameter)

The expected variation is tiny ($\sim 10^{-15}$), but measurable in principle.

.12 Ontological Consideration: Calculations as Constructs

The Fundamental Epistemological Limit

Ontological Limit

All calculations are human constructs.

They can **at best** give a certain idea of reality.

That calculations are internally consistent proves little about actual reality.

Mathematical consistency $\neq$ ontological truth

Einstein's Construct vs. T0's Construct

Both are human thought structures:

Einstein's construct:

- $E = mc^2$ (mathematically consistent)
- Relativity theory (internally coherent)
- 10 field equations (work computationally)
- **But:** Based on arbitrary c-constant setting

T0's construct:

- $E = m$ (mathematically simpler)
- $T \cdot m = 1$ (internally coherent)
- $\partial^2 E = 0$ (works computationally)
- **But:** Also only a human thought model

The Ontological Relativity

What is "really" real?

- **Einstein's space-time?** (construct)
- **T0's energy field?** (construct)
- **Newton's absolute time?** (construct)
- **Quantum mechanics' probabilities?** (construct)

All are human interpretive frameworks of the inaccessible reality.

Why T0 May Still Be Preferable

Not because of "absolute truth," but because of:

1. **Simplicity (Occam's Razor):**

- $E = m$ is simpler than $E = mc^2$
- One equation is simpler than 10 equations
- Fewer arbitrary assumptions

2. Consistency:

- None of the tensions described above
- No constant arbitrariness
- Unified thought structure

3. Predictive power:

- Testable predictions
- Fewer free parameters
- Clearer experimental distinction

4. Aesthetics:

- Mathematical simplicity
- Conceptual clarity
- Unity

The Epistemological Humility

T0 does not claim to be "absolute truth."

T0 only says:

- "Here is a **simpler** construct"
- "With **fewer** arbitrary assumptions"
- "That is, in the T0 assessment, **more consistent**"
- "And makes **more testable** predictions"

But ultimately T0 also remains a human thought structure.

The Pragmatic Consequence

Since all theories are constructs:

Evaluation criteria are:

1. **Simplicity** (fewer assumptions)
2. **Consistency** (no contradictions)
3. **Predictive power** (testable consequences)
4. **Aesthetics** (clarity of form)
5. **Unity** (fewer separate domains)

By these criteria T0 fares well in its own assessment – without claiming to be "absolutely true".

The Ontological Humility

The key statement:

- **Reality itself** is inaccessible
- **All theories** are human constructs
- **Mathematical consistency** proves no ontological truth

- **The best we have: Simpler, more consistent constructs**

From the T0 viewpoint, the c-constant setting was a convention decision that was later often read as a law of nature.

T0's advantage is not absolute truth, but simplicity as a thought model.

.13 The Practical Consequences

Why $E=mc^2$ "Works"

$E=mc^2$ works because:

- It is mathematically identical to $E = m$
- c^2 compensates the "frozen" time dynamics
- The T0 form ($E = m$) is contained in it
- Local approximations usually suffice

When $E=mc^2$ Fails

According to T0 expectation [S] deviations become visible at:

- Very precise measurements
- Extreme conditions (high energies/masses)
- Cosmological scales
- Quantum gravity

T0's Universal Validity

In T0 theory $E = m$ holds everywhere:

- No approximations needed
- No constant assumptions
- Universal applicability
- Fundamental simplicity

.14 A Reinterpretation of Physics History

Einstein's Achievement from the T0 Viewpoint

In natural units Einstein's discovery reads:

$$E = m \quad (\text{in natural form}) \quad (39)$$

His choice of convention was:

$$E = mc^2 \quad (\text{with the conversion factor } c^2) \quad (40)$$

The Historical Classification

An Observation

In natural units Einstein's relation reads $E = m$;
in SI units it appears as $E = mc^2$.
T0 theory attributes fundamental significance to the simple form.

.15 The T0 Perspective: c as Living Ratio

c as Expression of Time-Mass Duality

In T0 theory:

$$c(x, t) = f\left(\frac{L(x, t)}{T(x, t)(x, t)}\right) = f\left(\frac{L(x, t) \cdot m(x, t)}{1}\right) \quad (41)$$

since $T(x, t) \cdot m = 1$.

c becomes an expression of the fundamental time-mass duality.

The Dynamic Speed of Light

T0 prediction [S]:

$$c(x, t) = c_0 \sqrt{1 + \xi \frac{m(x, t) - m_0}{m_0}} \quad (42)$$

According to this formula, light moves faster in more massive regions.
(Tiny effect, but measurable in principle)

.16 Experimental Tests of c-Variability

Proposed Experiments

Test 1 - Gravitational dependence:

- Measure c in different gravitational fields
- T0 prediction: c varies with $\sim \xi \times \Delta\Phi_{\text{grav}}$

Test 2 - High-energy physics:

- Measure c in particle accelerators at highest energies
- T0 prediction: Tiny deviations at $E \sim \text{TeV}$

Expected Results

Experiment	Einstein (c constant)	T0 (c variable)
Gravitational field	$c = 299792458 \text{ m/s}$	$c(1 \pm 10^{-15})$
High energy	$c = \text{constant}$	$c(1 + 10^{-16})$

Table 5: Predicted c-variations